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Title Document Overview



Title documents and most supporting documentation is required to be scanned into MAX. View the [Document Management](#) topic for more information on required T&R documents to scan.

Arizona Titles

An Arizona Certificate of Title (title) is the ownership document of a vehicle that is titled in Arizona. The title is valid for the life of the vehicle, provided the vehicle ownership remains the same.

When the owner of a vehicle, titled in Arizona, decides to sell their vehicle to an individual, company, or dealership, the **current** Arizona paper title or [Title Transfer \(Bill of Sale\)](#), [form #38-1306](#) must be properly signed,

- For additional information, see [Company or Dealership: Completing the Buyer or Seller Section on Title](#) if it is a company or dealership that is buying or selling a vehicle for signature requirements
- For additional information, see the [Forms Required for T & R topic > Title Transfer \(Bill of Sale\)](#) section for more information on the bill of sale

Once a title is properly signed, the title will represent acceptable proof of ownership and will be surrendered to the buyer. The properly signed Arizona title will then be used to transfer ownership to the new buyer.



A signature is acceptable if it is within the signature block, or if it is adjacent to (above, below, left, right) the signature block if there are no other conflicting signatures which would call into question the validity of that signature.

When a vehicle is sold on an 'open title' (the first purchaser of a vehicle, as shown on the sold notice filed with Division (if applicable), sells the vehicle to another person without first obtaining title) the Division will allow the owner in possession of the signed title to be entered on the title as the purchaser.

Current Arizona Title (December 2023 - Present)

► [Description of Front of Arizona Title \(December 2023 - Present\)](#)

▶ **Description of Back of Arizona Title (December 2023 - Present)**

Previous Arizona Titles

- ▶ **November 2023 - Present**
- ▶ **September 2022 - October 2023**
- ▶ **April 2020 - September 2022**
- ▶ **1992 - April 2020**
- ▶ **Additional Examples of Arizona Titles**

Manufactured Certificate of Origin

The Manufactured Certificate of Origin (MCO) is the birth certificate document for any vehicle or trailer issued by all vehicle manufacturers (Ford, GMC, Honda, etc.) and is sent the licensed dealership for every vehicle the dealership purchases.

- ▶ **Description of Front of MCO**
- ▶ **Description of Back of MCO**

Out-of-State Title Documents

There are two different scenarios for out-of-state titles:

1. A customer has moved to the state of Arizona and is becoming a resident
2. An out-of-state person sells their vehicle to an Arizona resident

- This scenario requires the title to be properly re-assigned and endorsed

An Arizona resident, who is to be the new owner of the vehicle, must obtain a title in their name before selling or transferring ownership to another person, company, or dealer.

- ▶ **Bill of Sales with Out-of-State Titles/Vehicles**
- ▶ **Out-of-State Title: Previous Title Information Blank**

Additional Acceptable Ownership Documentation

- ▶ **Canadian Proof of Ownership**
- ▶ **Imported Vehicles Documentation**
- ▶ **Imported Vehicles: Military Documentation**
- ▶ **Tribal Title Documentation**
- ▶ **Mexico Documentation**
- ▶ **Souvenir Title**
- ▶ **When to Charge Title Fees**

Policies

8.2.1 General Title Information

Forms

[Bill of Sale, form #48-2004](#)

[Title and Registration Application, form #96-0236](#)

[Title Only Certification, form #48-0107](#)

[Title Transfer \(Bill of Sale\), form #38-1306](#)

Charts

[Converting Out of State Legal Status to Arizona](#)

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »

» [Customer Portal](#) »

Last Updated: May 08, 2026